“The Meister wasn’t pleased.” She settled opposite him. “Jana, who sits next to me on the production line, was two under the quota today.”

“Did you tell her your plan?” His eyebrows lifted.

“No, but since we’ve been working together for so long, we’re in a certain rhythm. I think she noticed I’ve slowed down.”

Rose didn’t tell him she’d made a secret wish that everyone on the factory floor wouldn’t meet their quota—anything to try and reduce the number of gunsights and rangefinders to be placed on German tanks and airplanes. “I think she understands what I’m doing and is trying to do the same.”

“Excellent.” André pumped a fist in the air. “If everyone in the factory slows down, then the overall production suffers without the Meister being able to blame one person.” He smiled. “I call it sly sabotage.”

“He’s been observing us more closely. I think if he could, he’d crack the whip over our shoulders like we’re horses, forcing us to move faster.”

André shook his head. “He can’t risk damaging the cylinders. Those items are expensive to produce. That’s why you’ve got more power than you think.”

She glanced at the sketch on the table. “What are you drawing?” She pointed to the image on the paper—a building with massive windows, a flat roof and a tree in the center of a courtyard.

“Show me first your sketchbook. I want to see the portraits you’ve done this week.”

Rose handed him the book. He thumbed through the pages. “These are excellent.”

“Now, you tell me, what are you drawing?”

“Our house. One day I will build it for you and we will live there together.”

She laughed. “Must it be so big?”

“Depends.” He rested a hand on hers—a craftsman’s hands. She loved their heft and how they could turn what was in his head into something concrete that she could step inside. “Tell me how many rooms you want.”

“Just one for us.”

He reached over and swept a strand of loose hair from her face. “What I’m asking is how many children should we have?”

Rose had never thought about having children. She’d seen her mother